

which are generally taken to describe an arsenal, a storeroom, the men's quarters in a house, or perhaps a temple or a hero shrine. The poem ends with an exhortation "not to forget" these things. Marzullo follows a previous interpretation, in opting for a temple where the arms of defeated enemies have been dedicated to Ares as the poem's setting; he also argues that the poem is complete and constitutes Alcaeus's call to arms (for the equipment described is still usable) to his political allies to overthrow the party in power and thus fits in with much that we know about Alcaeus's political career. Marzullo's main new contribution interprets the "shields thrown down" not as if they are lying on the floor, but as abandoned by the enemy in flight. Alcaeus, like Archilochus before him and Anacreon and Horace after, claims to be a *ripsaspis*, but whether it is a historical fact or a literary topos is unclear. Marzullo also sees the poem's form and content as emblematic of the "rise of the individual," an evolutionary view now somewhat out of favor. The volume's more than 200 pages contain much else, some of it relevant, some not; footnotes extending over several pages, much in the way of polemics, but rather less in the way of engaging recent—and mainly Italian—work on the poem, musical and artistic analogies, and some amusing asides. A more focused article might have had a greater impact.

Jenny Strauss Clay
University of Virginia

EMPEDOKLES PHYSIKA I: EINE REKONSTRUKTION DES ZENTRALEN GEDANKENGANGS. By Oliver Primavesi. Archiv für Papyrusforschung 22. Berlin: Walter de Gruyter, 2008. Pp. 84, plates; Cloth, \$63.00.

In 1999, Primavesi was co-editor of the *editio princeps* of a papyrus containing a substantial chunk of the first book of Empedocles' *Physika* that had languished in Strasbourg for almost one hundred years, forming the cartonnage for a collar of copper leaves decorating a mummy, and that overlapped with fragments known from Simplicius. Its publication substantially increased our knowledge of this enigmatic Pre-Socratic and inevitably raised more questions than it solved. In this slender but densely argued volume, Primavesi offers a revised and more elaborate reconstruction of Empedocles' book, incorporating the new fragments with Simplicius's quotations, which adds to the previous sequence of lines 232-300 from Book One (the line number indicated in the papyrus) a reconstruction of 30 additional lines that end in what Primavesi calls a *didaktischen Excurs*. This in turn is taken up in further fragments of the papyrus and additional material supplied by Simplicius, which is followed by a return to the exposition of the representation of the cosmic cycle and its alternations of Love and Strife. Primavesi believes that only during the empire of Love do mortal beings come into being; further, although he accepts that some of the so-called apocalyptic fragments belong to the *Physica* and recognizes an "analogy" between the *daimones* of the *Katharmoi*, Primavesi denies that the doctrine of metempsychosis has any role in the Empodocles' physical

doctrine, and regards its importation into the *Physics* as an offense against the *principle of charity* [sic]. In fact, the new Empedocles has rekindled the debate as to whether the *Katharmoi* were a separate work, and whether Empedocles might have used the notion of the transmigration of the soul as a metaphor as Plato, for example, did in his myth of Er. Much here is persuasive; much also promises to continue the debate, which Primavesi has put on a more solid footing. Primavesi's reconstruction is essential to all further discussion of Empedocles' astounding cosmology.

Jenny Strauss Clay
University of Virginia

CICERO'S PHILIPPICS: HISTORY, RHETORIC AND IDEOLOGY. Edited by Tom Stevenson and Marcus Wilson. Prudentia 37 and 38. Auckland, NZ: Polygraphia Ltd. 2008. Pp. x + 374. N.p.

This volume comprises papers delivered at a conference on Cicero's *Philippics* held at the University of Auckland (2003) and articles solicited for the volume from established Anglophone scholars. The editors' primary aim is to "give renewed attention to the *Philippics* after a period of disparagement and (consequent) marginalization" initiated by the withering pronouncement of the great Roman historian R. Syme (1939) that "the survival of the *Philippics* imperils historical judgment and wrecks historical perspective." Many of the articles concern the values and ideas in the *Philippics*, such as the notion of the tyrant (S. R. Pitcher), *libertas* (E. Cowan), *clementia* (N. Angel), and *felicitas* (K. Welch). Those on particular speeches within the corpus likewise stress themes in Cicero's self-presentation (C. Steel on *Phil.* 6, J. Hall on *Phil.* 12) and the complementary interplay of praise and blame in *Phil.* 10, 11 (T. Dawes). The articles in this volume, taken in sum, uphold Syme's view that Cicero's *Philippics* are of limited utility for the writing of the political history of Rome, yet nevertheless demonstrate their importance for understanding its intellectual and literary history. Students of the *Philippics* and of late Republican intellectual history alike will find the volume of use in becoming familiar with the current terms of the debate on this still indisputably great corpus of speeches.

Anna Stelow
University of Virginia

Christian Origins

THE PEOPLES' COMPANION TO THE BIBLE. Edited by Curtiss Paul DeYoung, et al. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress Press, 2010. Pp. xxxii + 291; plates, maps. Paper, \$29.00.

This "companion" attempts to interpret the Bible through the eyes of other peoples, both ancient and modern. Through the diverse insights of Africans, Asians, Hispanics, women, and others, biblical interpretation is enriched and the original multiculturalism of the Bible itself is more fully appreciated. The volume is in no sense a commentary, since

only brief introductions are devoted to the individual books (including Deuterocanonicals) of the Old and New Testaments. Rather, the 55 contributors, belonging to many religious traditions, explain in lengthy articles a plethora of relevant themes: Christian use of the OT; timeline for the Hebrew Bible; the people of God and the peoples of the earth; and many others. The occasional pastoral applications of texts do not deter from, but actually enhance, the moderately critical tone of the treatise. For example, the *herem* is said to be “troubling and difficult to reconcile with other biblical portrayals of God,” although no attempt is made to explain the inconsistency. Or again, “[the Book of Judges] should be read as a document of pro-monarchical propaganda.” Excellent maps, color plates of biblical art works, a select bibliography, and photos of apposite modern historical events serve to illustrate the Bible’s ancient and contemporary relevance. Though readers will hardly agree with its every statement, for biblical novices or journeymen/women, this engaging treatise can provide thought-provoking insights on the Bible as a “crossroads of culture.”

Casimir Bernas
Holy Trinity Abbey

SCM STUDYGUIDE TO NEW TESTAMENT INTERPRETATION. By Ian Boxall. London: SCM Press, 2007. Pp. 217. \$29.99.

An excellent addition to the *SCM Studyguide* series, this is one of two contributions by Boxall. Its equally good companion volume, *SCM Studyguide to the Books of the New Testament* (2007), focuses on the histories of the NT texts and the traditions that informed them. It makes a wonderful complement to this book, which provides a tour through the hermeneutical practices by which NT texts have been interpreted. Boxall’s work serves as an introduction to NT exegesis and to hermeneutics more generally. Its pedagogical strength lies in a series of helpful “To Do” and “Reflection” activities that invite readers/students to practice the various interpretive skills, ranging from textual criticism to historical, literary, social-scientific, advocacy, and theological approaches. Boxall succeeds at making these and other exegetical issues and contemporary hermeneutical conversations accessible while taking seriously their complexity. In careful and nuanced ways, he maps the current debates and engages with enduring questions of the NT’s interpretation, including the history of its reception and its on-going reflection in art, music, and film. The work culminates by attending to a single NT passage, illustrating again the whole range of questions and approaches included in this excellent undergraduate or beginning study guide.

Shane Kirkpatrick
Anderson University

JESUS IN AN AGE OF TERROR: SCHOLARLY PROJECTS FOR A NEW AMERICAN CENTURY. By James G. Crossley. London: Equinox Publications, 2008. Pp. xvi + 265. Hardcover, \$95.00, Paper, \$29.95.

As contemporary biblical scholarship becomes increasingly interdisciplinary, the scholars who choose to venture into this complex web must demonstrate considerable breadth. Crossley epitomizes this direction with his production of a history of NT interpretation based not only upon integration of sociological and political scholarship, but via ever increasing pop culture influences (specifically, bibliobloggers). He argues that many current NT scholars buy into a religio-academic version of Noam Chomsky’s propaganda model. Crossley interrogates uncritical acceptance of inaccurate and racist propagandizing of Islam as a religion and Arabs as a people. These scholars are often driven (consciously or unconsciously) by the Zionist interests of nations (particularly the United States and the United Kingdom) engaged in Middle Eastern conflicts. Crossley locates this most recent course of twentieth-century NT studies as a result of Israel’s victory in the Six Day War of 1967. He suggests that questions surrounding the historical Jesus and Christian origins shift substantially to Jesus’ Jewishness and renewed inquiry into first century and contemporary anti-Semitism. He then situates such motivation around cultural, political, and religious superiority of Anglo-American scholarship. This work requires broad familiarity with contemporary biblical scholarship as well as current figures and events. Responses will surely be diverse. His post-colonial approach will be welcomed by some, while questioned by others, particularly among pro-American Christian scholars. Either way, Crossley demonstrates that the political and cultural tensions among contemporary religions will require biblical scholars to cultivate an expansive worldview in order to navigate readers through the tumultuous storms of biblical interpretation.

Martin W. Mittelstadt
Evangel University

WHAT IS ASIAN AMERICAN BIBLICAL HERME-NEUTICS? READING THE NEW TESTAMENT. By Tat-Siong Benny Liew. Honolulu: University of Hawai’i Press, 2008. Pp. xiv + 258. Paper, \$37.00.

Liew, who teaches NT at the Pacific School of Religion in Berkeley, California, has produced the first full monograph on this topic. The highlights of the book include discussions across the major genre of NT writings—including the synoptic and autoptic gospels, Acts, Pauline letters, and the Apocalypse—seamless interfaces between Asian American studies literature and biblical scholarship, and deft handling of modern critical and late- or post-modern sources. Liew postures himself unapologetically on the reader-response horizon and in the Asian American field while writing in a mode and style that confidently engages the world of biblical studies in general. He is most successful in arguing for the relevance of the ethnic Asian American lens when interacting with the existing conversation and debates regarding postcolonial hermeneutics and the Greco-Roman background against which the NT documents were produced. Particularly noteworthy is the illumination of the contempo-

rary discussion of socio-rhetorical hermeneutics via explication of the class, ethnic, social, and economic realities underneath the Jew-Gentile relationship throughout the NT, including the complexities involved when Hellenistic Judaism is factored in. There are close readings of the Christian testament as well as more general discussions and readings of readings—both scholarly and more popular—of the NT. This volume is essential for any scholarly library and raises the stakes of the conversation as well since now others will have to argue against Liew rather than simply dismiss such ethnic hermeneutical approaches as parochial and “contextual” efforts.

Amos Yong

Regent University School of Divinity

THE INVENTION OF CHRISTIAN DISCOURSE. By Vernon K. Robbins. Rhetoric of Religious Antiquity Series 1. Blandford Forum, UK: Deo Publishing, 2009. Pp. xxx + 565. Paper, \$39.95.

According to Robbins, the six generally accepted systems of rhetorical discourse in the ancient world (wisdom, prophetic, apocalyptic, pre-creation, priestly, miraculous) assisted and inspired the oral and written sources and presentation of incipient Christianity. These forms of discourse contained distinguishing patterns of subjects, types of argument, and justifying proofs. These rhetorical forms were amalgamated into three literary arrangements contained in the NT: Gospels and Acts (biography and history); letters; Apocalypse. Christians, who co-acted and interacted with rabbinic Judaism and the religions of the Greco-Roman world, were thereby able to express their experiences and imaginings, which were often both traditional and at times inexpressible, in new and challenging ways. Robbins’s lengthy treatise (a second volume is to follow), laced with the technical jargon of various linguistic specializations, will at first appear formidable to the uninitiated. On further reading, however, one notices the repetition of familiar themes: any literature owes much to its environment; no religion begins or exists in a vacuum. In addition, readers will appreciate the many well-expressed insights into both the New and Old Testaments. Scholars first, but then serious students, will profit from Robbins’s endeavors.

Casimir Bernas

Holy Trinity Abbey

SACRED SCRIPTURE: A SHORT HISTORY OF INTERPRETATION. By Richard N. Soulen. Louisville, KY: Westminster John Knox Press, 2009. Pp. xv + 216. Paper, \$24.95.

Proceeding from his position as a Methodist pastor and teacher, Soulen presents a brief history (a “basic discussion”) of biblical interpretation, which he readily admits treats only a limited part of an immense field of study. Thus, he omits any in-depth discourse regarding Catholic and Orthodox exposition. Nevertheless, most important ques-

tions are discussed: the sacredness of Scripture; manuscript tradition; how the Bible interprets itself; exegesis in the early church; the senses (literal and otherwise) and the center of Scripture; modern and contemporary interpretation. I agree with Soulen that a satisfying solution to the “word-for-word” versus “dynamic equivalent” translation controversy is that of “formal equivalence,” as long as the version is provided with interpretative annotations. And I would add: without the receptor version being burdened with archaic English such as is still found in the “Io!”, for example, of the New American Bible. All in all, Soulen’s treatise is certainly personal in content and organization, but for all of that, no less engaging for students and teachers.

Casimir Bernas

Holy Trinity Abbey

THE MESSAGE OF ACTS IN CODEX BEZAE: A COMPARISON WITH THE ALEXANDRIAN TRADITION. VOLUME IV, ACTS 18, 24-28, 31: ROME VIA EPHESUS AND JERUSALEM. By Josep Rius-Camps and Jenny Read-Heimerdinger. Library of New Testament Studies 415. New York: T & T Clark, 2009. Pp. xiv + 418. Cloth, \$140.00.

This is the final volume of the authors’ project to compare the text of Codex Bezae (D/05, c. 400), “a cohesive and coherent work” in its own right, with the better-known “Alexandrian” version of Acts. They believe that Bezae preserves a form of Acts that 1) predates the Alexandrian text (“a revision” of Bezae, the result of “a sustained and deliberate attempt to modify the message” to make it “more comprehensible and more acceptable to later generations”); 2) represents a significantly different story of the church’s earliest days (one whose focus is primarily theological rather than historical); and 3) is written from a first-century Jewish perspective. As they explicate their metanarrative, the authors offer a host of detailed observations and proposed explanations of individual episodes. The episodes involving Apollos/Apollonius and the believers in Ephesus (18:24-19:7) offer fine examples of their approach and insights, which constantly drive one, like the Bereans, back to the texts to see “if these things are so.” In the end, this reader, at least (admittedly perhaps too under the thrall of traditional views to appreciate their case, or perhaps merely still convinced that the textual history implied by this view of Bezae is so extraordinarily improbable), remains unpersuaded. One may nonetheless learn much from the authors’ close (and often intertextual) reading of Acts and appreciate the undeniable erudition, skill, insight, and patience with which the authors present their stimulating and provocative case.

Michael W. Holmes

Bethel University

THE SOCIAL SCIENCES AND BIBLICAL TRANSLATION. Edited by Dietmar Neufeld. SBL Symposium Series 41. Atlanta, GA: Society of Biblical Literature, 2008. Pp. ix + 188. \$24.95.

A collection of interesting and sometimes exceptional essays arising out of the SBL Context Group that seeks to apply the insights of cultural anthropology and the social sciences to the task of translation and interpretation. Contributors (and topics) include R. Rohrbaugh ("Foreignizing Translation"), Z. Crook (grace as benefaction in Pauline texts), R. DeMaris (correction vs. purification in 1 Cor 5), the editor (sin and forgiveness in Mark 2:1-12), A. Batten (language of poverty and wealth in James), J. H. Elliott (God as zealous and jealous, but never envious—perhaps the best essay in the collection), J. Pilch (a "meaning response" understanding of healing accounts), C. Leeb ("Translating the Hebrew Body into English Metaphor") and R. Kugler (4QMMT and Qumran "anti-language"). The final essay, by J. Sandys-Wunsch, offers a perceptive critique of the other essays, noting the problematic nature of "social sciences"; that the perspective from which they operate has in one form or another been around for considerably longer than the introduction indicates; the problematic nature of any broad generalizations about "Mediterranean culture"; and the close parallels between much of the work in the essays and what for a long time was described as basic "philology" or exegesis—in all, a fitting response to the hubris of the introduction, which exhibits no less a degree of cultural captivity than the "North American translations" it excoriates.

Michael W. Holmes
Bethel University

TRANSLATING THE NEW TESTAMENT: TEXT, TRANSLATION, THEOLOGY. Edited by Stanley E. Porter and Mark J. Boda. McMaster NT Studies. Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans, 2009. Pp. xvi + 360. \$36.00.

This essay collection is the fruit of a conference celebrating the one-hundredth anniversary of the Canadian Bible Society, which sought to bring together discussion of topics often treated in isolation from one another: text, translation, and theology. Contributors include B. Aland, P. Comfort, and M. A. Robinson (Text); A. Gignac, L. T. Johnson, and S. E. Porter and M. B. O'Donnell (Translation); and E. M. Humphrey, E. Tamez, F. Watson, and K. K. Yeo (Theology). In addition to their individual contributions, each author was asked to bring her or his perspective to bear on a common text, Luke 16:19-31. An introduction by Porter and a concluding assessment by R. N. Longenecker frame the other essays. Virtually all the essays are excellent; the whole, however, is in this instance perhaps less than the sum of its parts. The concept of using a single passage as a common point of reference for all contributors is an excellent one, but the execution by the contributors is uneven; for example, the textual critics simply talk past one another, and so the anticipated interaction is more of a miss than a hit overall. Nonetheless, in all a thoughtful and often stimulating set of contributions.

Michael W. Holmes
Bethel University

CUTTING JESUS DOWN TO SIZE: WHAT HIGHER CRITICISM HAS ACHIEVED AND WHERE IT LEAVES CHRISTIANITY. By G. A. Wells. LaSalle, IL: Open Court, 2009. Pp. x + 394. Paper, \$44.95.

According to the author, this book is designed to delineate some of the major achievements of higher criticism of the NT over the last few centuries, and to defend these achievements against contemporary detractors, that is, those associated with "a resurgence of fundamentalist and ultra-conservative Christian belief" as well as "the defensive tactics of more liberal commentators." The eight chapters focus on such topics as: miracles and historical method (through the lens of D. Strauss), the virgin birth, the resurrection, the nature of Mark's Gospel, the Sayings Gospel Q, and Jesus as (a failed) apocalyptic prophet. While some of the material is drawn from previous publications, much of it is new. For those who (based upon his works published in the seventies and eighties) still associate Wells's name with the Christ Myth theory, this book will come as a surprise. Wells no longer claims that the Jesus of the gospels is without any grounding in actual history. Rather, he now holds that the gospels represent a fusion of two originally independent traditions: the mythical, supernatural Christ-figure of the early epistles on one hand, and traditions that can be traced back to "the activity of a Galilean preacher of the early first century, the personage represented in Q" on the other.

Paul Rhodes Eddy
Bethel University

THE PREACHING OF JESUS: GOSPEL PROCLAMATION, THEN AND NOW. By William Brosend. Louisville, KY: Westminster John Knox Press, 2010. Pp. xix + 180. Paper, \$19.95.

This volume is a treatise on giving effective sermons today based on the methods used by Jesus himself. Brosend understands these methods to have been dialogical (using the Scriptures, tradition, culture of the time, and events in the lives of the audience); proclamatory (provocative and prophetic); limiting the use of reference to one's own person (true of Jesus in the Synoptics); and figurative (use of vivid description and analogy, as in the parables; Jesus surpassed others in the art of "rhetorical fabrication"). Among Brosend's comments: separation of church and state was foreign to the world and ideas of Jesus; everything for him was political, that is, concerned with the community (the original meaning of polis, the city-state). In this sense, modern sermons can and should be political. In short, relying on solid exegesis, Brosend provides profound insights that should inspire preachers of all denominations to make their sermons and homilies more appetizing and effective.

Casimir Bernas
Holy Trinity Abbey

THE COMMON TRADITION BEHIND SYNOPTIC SAYINGS OF JUDGMENT AND JOHN'S APOCALYPSE: AN ORAL INTERPRETIVE TRADITION OF OLD TESTAMENT PROPHETIC MATERIAL. By Paul T. Penley. LNTS 424. New York: T & T Clark, 2010. Pp. xii + 185. Cloth, \$110.00.

Penley, professor of New Testament at Moody Bible Institute, has set a difficult task for himself. He seeks to demonstrate that the book of Revelation and the Synoptic gospels (particularly Matthew and Luke) draw upon a common set of oral traditions—traditions that Penley sometimes seems to infer to have originated with the historical Jesus. In order to accomplish this task, Penley first tries to isolate a series of oral traditions in Revelation 1:3, 7; 6:16; 11:2, 20; 18:20, 24; 22:30 and their parallels in Matthew 23:34-35; 24:30; and 26:18 and in Luke 11:49-51; 21:8, 24, 35, and 23:30. After conducting a careful analysis of these texts' shared vocabulary, phrases, grammar, syntax, ideas, and contexts, Penley argues that the texts in Revelation draw upon oral traditions which they shared with Matthew and Luke. Although Penley labors to emphasize the supposedly fixed, identifiable, and stable character of these oral traditions, many readers—including this reviewer—will remain unconvinced that Penley's parallels are best explained by any discernable or consistent trajectory of oral tradition. Only the most generous analysis of Penley's thesis would concede more than the fact that Penley has raised an interesting possibility about the interplay of these synoptic and apocalyptic traditions.

Thomas E. Phillips

Point Loma Nazarene University

BIBLICAL INTERPRETATION IN EARLY CHRISTIAN GOSPELS. VOLUME 2: THE GOSPEL OF MATTHEW. Edited by Thomas R. Hatina. Library of New Testament Studies 310. New York: T & T Clark, 2008. Pp. v + 232. Cloth, \$130.00.

This is the second volume of a five-volume series examining the function of embedded biblical texts within early Christian gospels through the integration of narrative, social-scientific, and historical criticism. The presence of Jewish scripture and the use of "formulae quotations" is particularly prominent in the second gospel, a thread which connects the seemingly disparate essays that comprise this insightful contribution to the method and practice of early Christian composition. Each essay, more or less, surveys the scholarly tradition, explores the problem of method, and offers a fresh exegetical analysis of a number of well-known Matthean traditions. Contributors include M. A. Apodaca, W. Carter, J. R. C. Cousland, C. A. Evans, M. Goodacre, C. A. Ham, Hatina, M. P. Knowles, J. Nolland, L. Novakovic, A. G. van Aarde, and L. M. Wills. This volume, and the series as a whole, represents an important step forward in our growing understanding of the complexities of the compositional history of early Christian literature.

Matthew R. Hauge

Claremont Graduate University

RETHINKING THE UNITY AND RECEPTION OF LUKE AND ACTS. Edited by Andrew F. Gregory and C. Kevin Rowe. Columbia: University of South Carolina Press, 2010. Pp. xv + 226. Cloth, \$49.95.

Since the 1993 appearance of Parsons and Pervo's *Rethinking the Unity of Luke and Acts*, scholars have occasionally challenged the otherwise unquestioned unity of the two texts. Over the last half-decade, such challenges have gained momentum, with questions about the literary unity of Luke and Acts being supplemented by inquiries into the reception history of Luke and Acts as two distinct volumes. Gregory and Rowe conveniently encapsulate the state of scholarship on these two hotly debated scholarly issues through the essays collected in this volume. The first part introduces the discussions, the second part encapsulates the major contributions to the debates, and the third part examines the interpretive significance of the discussions. Both aspects of this project—challenging the unity of Luke-Acts and emphasizing the reception history of Luke and Acts—work against prevailing methodological assumptions of most critical scholarship. In spite of recent work, many scholars continue both to affirm the unity of Luke-Acts (like François Bovon in this volume) and to doubt the relevance of the texts' reception history (like Luke Johnson in this volume). In the final analysis, this book is significant as a collection of key scholarship, but ultimately offers few surprises to those who have been following these discussions over the last half dozen years.

Thomas E. Phillips

Point Loma Nazarene University

LUKE'S WEALTH ETHICS: A STUDY IN THEIR COHERENCE AND CHARACTER. By Christopher M. Hays. WUNT II/275. Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2010. Pp. xv + 347. Paper, €74.00.

As Hays himself acknowledges, this revised dissertation (Oxford, M. Bockmuehl) joins a crowded field of scholarship. Hays correctly argues that the central problem for interpreters of economic issues in Luke-Acts is the apparent diversity of teachings in Luke-Acts. For Hays, the primary interpretive task is to correlate the four major theological impulses behind Luke's treatment of wealth and generosity: imitation of God, eschatological expectation, the dangers of wealth, and obedience to the Law. Hays finds three contemporary approaches to correlating these impulses: interim readings (approaches which interpret the gospel's most stringent demands as limited to a particular time in Jesus' ministry); bi-vocational readings (approaches which apply different ethics to different groups within the Lukan community); and personalist readings (approaches that leave different individuals to derive different ethical commitments from Luke-Acts). Hays advocates for a mixture of the vocational and personalist reading strategies by insisting that Luke-Acts consistently calls for renunciation of wealth from all readers,

but that the particular form of renunciation which one adopts will be based upon one's Christian calling and current level of resources. This dissertation is clearly written and deals competently with both the canonical and non-canonical literature and the conclusions are plausible. Nevertheless, many readers will doubt that Hays has added much to scholarly discourse other than locating himself within the existing discussion of this already fully explored topic.

Thomas E. Phillips

Point Loma Nazarene University

PEOPLE OF THE SPIRIT: EXPLORING LUKE'S VIEW OF THE CHURCH. By Graham H. Twelftree. London: Society for Promoting Christian Knowledge; Grand Rapids, MI: Baker Academic, 2009. Pp. xvi + 269. Paper, \$24.99.

Twelftree makes a vast amount of information on ecclesiology in Luke-Acts accessible to a wide readership, incorporating careful analyses and often fresh conclusions on topics such as Pentecost, tongues, baptism, salvation, and the role of experiencing God. While cautioning wisely against a slavish adaptation of Luke's ecclesiology, the author's sensitivity to the potential impact of biblical scholarship on the modern shape of the church is indeed a strength of the book. For example, concerning church leadership, Twelftree frames the question in concepts relevant to current dialog: was Luke "an early catholic" trying to establish a Jerusalem hierarchy, or a Protestant who "advocated elected councils" functioning independently, or a charismatic proposing that the Spirit appoints and guides church leadership? He does not, however, condescend to his readership by avoiding controversial claims; he concludes, for instance, that Luke's view of mission did not involve "caring for the physical needs of the outsider," in contradistinction to the majority view of mission today. Copious citation of primary texts in the footnotes also makes the work a valuable reference, while, unfortunately, lack of citation to secondary literature neglects the educated reader who would like to engage the academic discussion more directly, a sacrifice of which Twelftree is aware. Nonetheless, *People of the Spirit* provides an indispensable springboard for examining Luke's view of the church.

Pamela Hedrick

High Point University

DWELLING IN THE HOUSEHOLD OF GOD: JOHANNINE ECCLESIOLOGY AND SPIRITUALITY. By Mary L. Coloe. Collegeville, MN: Liturgical Press, 2007. Pp. xii + 226. \$26.95.

Flowing nicely out of her first study of John's Gospel, *God Dwells with Us* (Liturgical Press, 2001), in which Coloe explored the symbol of "my Father's house," this study examines the symbol of "my Father's household," including the reciprocity inherent in the gospel's invitation. If her first

book was Christological, this book is ecclesial. Using the post-70 context of the Johannine community, Coloe explores how the symbol of "household" began to emerge as a conceptual and sociological symbol. Her premise is that "household" is a symbol that embraces the shift from place of cultic worship to place of divine activity, of God's dwelling within creation. By examining the household scenes in the Gospel, Coloe looks for "the code" in which the community's experience has been inscribed. On the whole, she draws a coherent picture of the household theme that helpfully explains a major thread of John's theology. In certain places it can feel like the cart (theme) is pulling the horse (text), yet Coloe's argument is so connected to the larger Johannine (and beyond) discussion that one is persuaded to see favorably the exegetical foundation, even if the conclusions might need some nuance. One is also left wondering if the symbol of "household," though obviously present, is the most comprehensive or accurate symbol to depict "Johannine ecclesiology and spirituality." In the end, Coloe has provided a synthetically exegetical and robustly theological reading of John that benefits both the academy and the church.

Edward W. Klink III

Talbot School of Theology, Biola University

THE PERICOPE ADULTERAE, THE GOSPEL OF JOHN, AND THE LITERACY OF JESUS. By Chris Keith. New Testament Tools, Studies and Documents 38. Leiden: Brill, 2009. Pp. xvi + 320. €119.00; \$169.00.

This revised dissertation, asking, "Why this passage, here?" argues two related claims: 1) John 8:6, 8 involve, on the part of the passage's interpolator, a claim for a "grapho-literate Jesus" (i.e., a Jesus who could write as well as read); and 2) the interpolation of 7:53-8:11 into the fourth gospel in the third century is a response to pagan and Jewish criticism of Christians and their founder as illiterate. After surveying previous research on 7:53-8:11, Keith examines the usage of *γράφω* and *καταγράφω*; writing and gradations of literacy; and scribal literacy in the NT environment (chs 1-4). Chapters 5-9 focus on the PA itself: its location; its context in John ch. 7; its narrative and coherence with its context; the intertextual relationship between John 8:6, 8 and Exodus 31:18, 32:15-16; and the socio-historical context in which interpolation is most likely to have happened. In short, the focus is not so much the PA itself (whose absence from the earliest version of John is assumed, and whose origin is not a concern), but the interpolator's understanding of the pericope and reasons for interpolating it in that location. Readers will overlook the occasional over-reaching typical of a dissertation more easily than the sometimes ambiguous and/or confusing writing style and unreliable index. Overall, Keith offers an often illuminating and informative reading of the PA, its interpolator, and his context that (though not compelling) is both coherent and plausible.

Michael W. Holmes

Bethel University

THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS IN THE GOSPEL OF JOHN. Edited by Craig R. Koester and Reimund Bieringer. WUNT 222. Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2008. Pp. v + 358. Cloth, €89.00.

This essay collection represents the combination of studies presented at several meetings of the Society for New Testament Studies, contributions written for this volume, and a reprinted article by S. M. Schneiders. Acknowledging the importance of the resurrection in the Fourth Gospel, these thirteen articles tackle questions centering on how exactly Jesus' resurrection fits into John's tradition history, its overall narrative structure, and theological goals. A majority of these essays examine ways in which the resurrection appearances of John's Gospel are imbedded in the narrative, highlighting connections to Gospel themes and scenes, especially those present in the Farewell Discourses. Other articles explore the resurrection appearances themselves, arguing for a variety of literary, tradition, and redaction-critical approaches to understand the distinctiveness of the Johannine tradition. A common element running throughout the entire collection of essays is an interest in the lasting effects of Jesus' resurrection, and especially the giving of the Paraclete, for the continuing community of believers. As a part of this ecclesiological focus, a number of these articles give extended attention to the interrelationship between John's realized and future eschatological tendencies. With a few notable exceptions (Nielson, Koester, Schneiders), this collection of essays does not provide particularly innovative approaches to Jesus's resurrection in the Fourth Gospel. Nevertheless, these essays offer helpful overviews on the current state of research and provide cogent summaries of past scholarship. This volume is valuable for its presentation of mature scholarly perspectives on Johannine ecclesiology, eschatology, and Christology for which future work must account.

Alicia D. Myers
Baylor University

THE GOSPEL ACCORDING TO SAINT JOHN. By Andrew T. Lincoln. Black's NT Commentary 4. London: Continuum/ New York: Hendrickson, n.d. Pp. ix + 584. Cloth, \$29.95.

Lincoln's commentary provides a helpful resource for students and scholars. The first ninety-one pages introduce issues such as authorship; historicity; relationship to the Synoptics and the Johannine Epistles; context and purpose; historicity; and its Christology in terms of Judaism. A brief list of further reading follows each point. The discussion of all these issues is balanced, critical, and provides a helpful summary of a broad range of current scholarship. In most cases, Lincoln's conclusions tend to be the current consensus of scholarship. In considering the Gospel sources, Lincoln takes the stance that the evangelist knew the Synoptics, which he uses along with other independent material in his own creative manner. The discussion of each biblical passage is informed by current scholarship, noting the likely

biblical allusions and traditions that lie behind the text. Without detracting from its usefulness, I have two criticisms. First, in his translations, Lincoln states that he "deliberately errs on the side of literalness." I would have preferred even greater literal equivalence for students who do not have Greek. Second, it would be helpful to continue to list a few key reading resources at the end of each passage to indicate further avenues of research. Given the nature of the Black's commentary series and its target audience, Lincoln succeeds in providing a clear and informative resource.

Mary Coloe
Australian Catholic University

SEEING THINGS JOHN'S WAY: THE RHETORIC OF THE BOOK OF REVELATION. By David A. DeSilva. Louisville, KY: Westminster John Knox Press, 2009. Pp. xiv + 393. \$39.95.

DeSilva's book demonstrates an approach that focuses explicitly on the rhetorical strategies and effects of Revelation. He adopts a "contemporary-historical" position that interprets Revelation as a situation-specific document best understood in reference to its original audiences. The book takes up matters of rhetorical setting, goals, and worldview, constructions of ethos and pathos, and Revelation's use of rational argument and the Hebrew Bible. The chapter on "literary logic," which addresses John's use of *ekphrasis* and the ways in which the narrative segments of Revelation convey rational argument, is particularly noteworthy. Here, DeSilva reads Revelation's extended prose descriptions as "narrative demonstrations" of certain claims John wants to impress upon his readers, and as "narrative projections" of presuppositions John expects his readers to share and uphold as a consequence of being part of the Christian community. The book concludes with an exploration of whether and in what manner Revelation is relevant to the contemporary church. Throughout, the book is an attentive study of the rhetoric of Revelation rather than a more traditional commentary on Revelation itself. DeSilva concerns himself with the latter strictly through the lens of the former. The distinction between rhetorical discourse and historical actuality is not always as clear as one might hope, although DeSilva is careful to nuance historical reconstructions and assessments in light of John's rhetorical perspective. The book's length and density make it best suited to graduate and seminary courses, particularly those of an exegetical nature.

Scott S. Elliott
Adrian College

THE PAUL-APOLLOS RELATIONSHIP AND PAUL'S STANCE TOWARD GRECO-ROMAN RHETORIC: AN EXEGETICAL AND SOCIO-HISTORICAL STUDY OF 1 CORINTHIANS 1-4. By Corin Mihaila. Library of New Testament Studies 402. London: T & T Clark, 2009. Pp. xix + 252. Cloth, \$140.00.

In this revised dissertation, Mihaila elucidates Paul's theology of preaching in 1 Corinthians 1-4 with the objective of exposing Paul's attitude toward sophistic rhetoric and the rhetorically-charged ministry of Apollos. After an initial chapter analyzing the literary and thematic unity of 1 Corinthians 1-4, M. investigates the nature of the *sophia* Paul avoids in his preaching, ruling out Gnostic and Hellenistic Jewish wisdom before making a case for reading Paul's discourse in the context of the budding Second Sophistic. Next, Mihaila argues that Paul earnestly opposed sophistic rhetoric and intentionally renounced the use of eloquence and bodily language as means of persuasion, since such were inconsistent with his theology of the cross and salvation. Finally, Mihaila argues that Apollos, though a capable orator, did not utilize sophistic methods, and thus was not opposed by Paul. Unfortunately, this book does not advance scholarship much beyond the foundational work of Litfin and Winter. Still unclear, for instance, is why "Paul repudiated the rhetorical techniques believed to be essential in securing a following," but utilized such devices in his letters, which allegedly "do not differ much from his oral communication." Nevertheless, specialists will find this book to be a valuable resource on the Corinthian correspondence.

John K. Goodrich
Moody Bible Institute

PAUL, HIS LETTERS, AND ACTS. By Thomas E. Phillips. Library of Pauline Studies. Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 2009. Pp. xi + 243. Paper, \$24.95.

Phillips argues modern variation in Pauline biography arises from debates begun by Baur, Knox, and Vielhauer over data in Paul's letters and in Acts. Phillips writes to "demarcate" the two images of Paul, noting what each corpus reveals about Paul's travels, his Greco-Roman context, his relationship with Peter and James, and his associates. He finds: Acts has the more elaborate data on Paul's travels, Acts often selects (and exaggerates?) Pauline biography to fit ideology, and Acts at times downplays conflict. The two presentations are, however, generally compatible. His book is copiously annotated, though many references have strained relevance. More seriously, despite heroic defense, conventional assumptions that lack textual basis still breach his argument. For example, Phillips seems to construct a "Virgin Paul" from 1 Cor. 7, he refers throughout to the "Christian" and "pre-Christian" Paul, and his analysis of Paul's "Greco-Roman" status is (too?) general and broad. His summary of Paul's travels and associates is, however, useful and complete, and his constant wrangling with the differences between Acts 15 and Galatians 2 covers all the important issues. *Paul* is well written and accessible. It will be of high value to advanced undergraduates, seminarians, pastors, and new scholars on Paul.

Robert Paul Seesengood
Albright College

ONE LORD, ONE PEOPLE: THE UNITY OF THE CHURCH IN ACTS IN ITS LITERARY SETTING. By Alan J. Thompson. Library of NT Studies 359. New York: T&T Clark, 2008. Pp. xvi + 218. Cloth, \$130.00.

Thompson's book is a significant contribution to Acts scholarship on the relatively neglected themes of unity and disunity, and it should take an essential place in the growing literature that re-examines the relationship between Acts and empire. His survey of the impact of literary portrayals of unity and disunity in ancient Jewish and Greco-Roman sources elucidates the magnitude of these principles in arguments for the proper exercise of law and of political sovereignty. Thompson argues persuasively that Luke attempts to demonstrate the legitimate reign of the resurrected Christ both by the unity of the new movement as well as by the discord among its opponents as the word "conquers" major cities of the Roman Empire. Highlights of the book include careful examinations of underlying parallels regarding law, such as those between the accounts of Sinai and Pentecost, an emphasis on the Spirit as a unifying force, and cogent presentations of common threads among episodes accentuating disunity among opponents as varied as the audiences at Athens and at Rome. The primary limitations of Thompson's conclusions are, first, that he assumes the historicity of Acts rather too readily from the evidence presented, and second, that any noteworthy difference between "unity" and "uniformity" among believers requires more exploration than it finally receives. *One Lord, One People* nonetheless provides a fresh and generally convincing perspective on an overarching literary strategy of Acts in its contemporary context.

Pamela Hedrick
High Point University

DOCUMENTS AND IMAGES FOR THE STUDY OF PAUL. Edited by Neil Elliott and Mark Reasoner. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress, 2011. Pp. xii + 418. Paper, \$35.00.

Elliott and Reasoner have provided a great service to anyone who wants to understand how Paul and his letters fit into the wider social and cultural environment of which they are a part. The book includes 221 entries organized by six broad categories: Paul's Self-Presentation (e.g., slave, philosopher, worker); Paul's Gospel and Letters (e.g., epistolography, rhetoric, Roman religion, theology); the Gospel of Augustus (e.g., imperial cult, colonial encounters); Paul's People-Israel (e.g., Diaspora, Torah, Judean-Roman relations); Communities Around Paul (e.g., purity, social order associations); and Paul's Legacy (e.g., pseudepigrapha, Gnosticism, asceticism). Each entry is given a brief introduction and each section concludes with a few "questions for reflection" and suggestions "for further reading." Augmenting the text are 112 black and white photographs and a map of the eastern Mediterranean. The book's use is facilitated by the inclusion of ample indexes (subjects, authors, biblical, and ancient texts). My one caution is the entries are drawn primarily from literary texts, which privileges the elite perspective and thus contextualizes Paul and his audience

while still excluding the perspectives of the latter, who would be among the numerically predominant non-elites of the empire. Nevertheless, this is a work that will be well thumbed by students and scholars alike.

Richard S. Ascough
Queen's University at Kingston

THE APOSTLE PAUL AND THE PAULINE TRADITION. By Stephen Finlan. Collegeville, MN: Liturgical Press, 2008. Pp. xiv + 229. \$29.95.

This is a basic introduction to Paul and the Pauline letters, useful as a textbook or overview for persons unacquainted with Pauline scholarship. After brief introductory chapters on the settings of the letters and Paul's career, the book covers each of the Pauline letters in approximate chronological sequence. Most attention is given to a sequential theological reading of each letter. Finlan thinks that Timothy had a major hand in the writing of Colossians, but that 2 Thessalonians, Ephesians, and the Pastorals were written by later persons carrying on the Pauline tradition. He also explores the Pauline tradition in Hebrews, 1 Peter, 1 John, *1 Clement*, Ignatius, Marcion, and Irenaeus. Finlan has a special interest in the themes of sacrifice and scapegoating. His reading of the letters interacts with current scholarship on crucial issues, and his views are fairly standard for the most part. It is refreshing to have an introduction that deals more with the letters' content than with the usual introductory issues such as authorship or provenance.

David Kuck
United Theological College of the West Indies

PAUL. By Geoffrey Harris. SCM Core Text. London: SCM Press, 2009. Pp. xv + 267. Paper. \$32.99.

Although intended to be a textbook on Paul, this book presumes a working knowledge of earliest Christianity and may be a bit of a challenge to the average student. Ten chapters follow the usual pattern of tracing Paul's Christian life, albeit according to Harris's understanding of the sequence of the letters, in which he follows a venerable English tradition and places Galatians first. The Pastorals, considered post-Pauline, are not included. Beneficial features of the book are the verse-by-verse commentary for key passages, along with a judiciously chosen list of publications at the end of each chapter. E. P. Sander's "new perspective" on Paul is explained and frequently the reader is reminded that Paul is no male chauvinist. Yet the format leaves one with a sense that this is a somewhat dated presentation. The maps and a curious chart on *The Writings and Traditions of Judaism* do nothing to alter this impression. This is a pity. There are substantive matters here. It will be useful for seminary classes but most undergraduate teachers will look for a more accessible presentation.

Allan J. McNicol
Austin Graduate School of Theology

THE MAKING OF PAUL: CONSTRUCTIONS OF THE APOSTLE IN EARLY CHRISTIANITY. By Richard I. Pervo. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress Press, 2010. Pp. xvi + 376. Paper, \$32.00.

This is a carefully argued and powerful case for understanding Paul in the way scholars have long understood Jesus, namely, that both were transformed post-mortem by the communities that communicated the memory of them, memories that were as much constructed as they were transmitted. Pervo carefully traces this process through the editing of Paul's individual letters, as well as their collection and publication; in the way Paul's letters are transformed from particular and situational to general and universal; in the way Paul moves from being one of several apostles to the Gentiles to the only one; in the continuation of Paul's legacy—and the increase in his authority—through the deutero-Pauline epistles, the non-canonical "Pauline" letters, and the Church Fathers such as Clement of Alexandria and Irenaeus; and the various acts of/or featuring Paul. This is a process that even includes anti-Paulinism and Gnostics who each in their own way interpreted Paul. As with Jesus, Paul's reach greatly increases after his death. This book is characteristic of Pervo's work: argued reasonably and with restraint, yet extremely provocative.

Zeba Crook
Carleton University

A FORMER JEW: PAUL AND THE DIALECTICS OF RACE. By Love L. Sechrest. Library of New Testament Studies 410. London: T & T Clark International, 2009. Pp. xii + 262. Cloth, \$130.00.

Previous works on race, ethnicity, and identity formation in the ancient world have presupposed a modern understanding of race and race relations. The primary shortcoming of this approach, according to Sechrest, is that religion does not play a role in contemporary constructions of race. It is this that has allowed previous scholarship to conclude that early Christians were not a "race," because race cannot refer to people classified by religion. Sechrest challenges this assumption by using contemporary social scientific research on race, and by taking at face-value the testimony of the ancient sources. In antiquity, claims Sechrest (and others), race and religion were intertwined. The gentiles are a race, the Jews are race, and thus, the Christians become a "third race." By this logic, Paul's conversion from Gentile to Christian resulted in a new ethno-racial identity. Sechrest's argument is provocative, but is limited by the heavy baggage the term "race" carries in the contemporary world. Finding an alternative term would have helped move the conversation forward.

Zeba Crook
Carleton University

THE DELIVERANCE OF GOD: AN APOCALYPTIC REREADING OF JUSTIFICATION IN PAUL.

By Douglas A. Campbell. Grand Rapids, MI: Eerdmans, 2009. Pp. xxx + 1 218. Cloth, \$60.00.

Campbell's book is a hermeneutically, historically, and exegetically sophisticated attempt to overthrow the traditional view of justification in Paul (based largely on Romans 1-4) which is individualist, contractual, and conditional, and replace it with his own rhetorical and apocalyptic rereading. In the first half of the book (Parts I-III), Campbell shows the difficulties of the traditional view by putting it in historical and philosophical perspective. He downplays the support that Augustine and Luther might actually lend to the theory and argues that the values of modern Western society share a strong (and disturbing) affinity with the traditional view. In the second half (Parts IV and V), Campbell argues that Romans, like Galatians, was written to negate the influence of "hostile countermissionaries" to whom he attributes much of the justification material in Romans 1:18-3:20. In Campbell's apocalyptic paradigm, salvation is not an offer (rationally accepted by the individual) rather is an unconditional liberating gift to humanity. His argument is exhaustive and many layered, though it is largely dependent on the historical situation he proposes for the letter, something many will question. The book will be an indispensable resource for anyone interested in the serious study of Paul.

Thomas M. Anderson
London School of Theology

NEW CREATION IN PAUL'S LETTERS: A STUDY OF THE HISTORICAL AND SOCIAL SETTING OF A PAULINE CONCEPT.

By T. Ryan Jackson. WUNT II/272. Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2010. Pp. xv + 232. Paper, \$80.00.

Jackson sets out to ascertain what Paul means by new creation in Gal. 6:11-18, 2 Cor. 5:11-21, and Rom. 8:18-25. But first he offers a brief history of the research and of early Christian interpretation, and then sets out in detail OT backgrounds, second temple perspectives, and Roman imperial ideology. He locates the OT backgrounds in Isaiah but not Ezekiel. In the second temple period he takes up Jubilees and the Dead Sea Scrolls and suggests that these communities, confronted with assimilation, declared that faithfulness contributes to the renewal of God's creation. The imperial ideology of Caesarian peace and prosperity, Paul believed, contrasted with that introduced by the crucifixion and resurrection. Jackson concludes that Paul's affirmations maintain a balance between anthropological and cosmological dimensions. "New creation" entails a new person being renewed in the image of Christ, a new community challenging the social order, and a new earth in the throes of renewal. This work offers an impressive fresh and balanced perspective on Paul's meaning regardless of quarrels with a few details.

Thomas H. Olbricht
Pepperdine University

WHAT ARE THEY SAYING ABOUT PAUL AND THE END TIME?

By Joseph Plevnik. Mahwah, NJ: Paulist, 2009.

Pp. x + 130. Paper, \$14.95.

Plevnik provides a survey of recent scholarship on Pauline eschatology conducted through a discussion of the relevant New Testament texts in that area. Having written extensively on the topic, he is well qualified for the task, and interacts ably with both primary and secondary sources. The introductory nature of the book restricts the scope of the work, which focuses primarily on the nature of the resurrection, the coming of the Lord, and the concept of hope in general. Plevnik's views are generally well argued, though his rejection of the Greco-Roman background for interpreting Paul's use of *parousia* is unpersuasive. The use of endnotes in this survey of scholarship is regrettable and makes laborious the use of this book for its intended purpose; footnotes would provide greater success in pointing readers on to the secondary material. It nevertheless remains a helpful study of several major themes in Pauline eschatology and will serve well as an introductory text at either the undergraduate or graduate level.

Matt O'Reilly
Jay United Methodist Church

CALLED FROM THE JEWS AND FROM THE GENTILES: PAULINE ECCLESIOLOGY IN ROMANS 9-11.

By Pablo T. Gadenz. WUNT II/267. Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2009. Pp. xii + 393. Paper, €79.00.

Gadenz's goal is quite modest: to discern Paul's ecclesiology in Rom 9-11. While the author divests himself of global Pauline claims, his focus on these chapters in this letter does reflect his belief that this letter represents Paul's "mature and sustained treatment" of the topic. Sustained they may be, relatively speaking, but the notion that the treatment in Romans is "mature" suggests a belief that Paul's thoughts on this, or any issue, developed in a linear fashion (a notion repeated in the conclusion), and that Romans represents its apex. It is not clear that such a belief is warranted or defensible, and it is not defended here. Gadenz applies methods that combine insights drawn from Greco-Roman rhetoric, ancient orality, and Midrashic methods of interpretation. He concludes that Paul intended for there to be two ethnic identities within Christianity—a Gentile-Christian ethnicity and a Jewish-Christian ethnicity—and that the identity of the former would be meaningless without the existence of the latter. And while both are meant to retain their ethnicity within Christianity, they are united in Christ. Though he does not defend his assumptions, Gadenz applies the methods responsibly, yet the net results are still modest and do not move the reader much beyond what is clear from the text itself.

Zeba Crook
Carleton University

SOUND MAPPING THE NEW TESTAMENT. By Margaret Ellen Lee and Bernard Brandon Scott. Salem, OR: Polebridge Press, 2009. Pp. 406. Paper, \$34.95.

Sound mapping, for Lee and Bernard, is an analytical tool, a visual display that builds upon the cliché that language is first of all sound; it attempts to clarify the structures of ancient languages through their acoustic features, not their appearance on the written page. This analysis of sound supplements but does not supplant other methods of Biblical interpretation. We cannot hear the ancients speaking today; nevertheless, features of sound such as the melodies hidden within manuscripts are encoded in the grammar of the written creation and can be recovered, regardless of the specific sound of the spoken language (a recording from antiquity would only be a first step in sound mapping). There is certainly much of value in this book, especially on the primacy of sound in language, the technology of writing, and the revolution in meaning with the rise of literacy. Despite this, the element of subjectivity in the theory of sound mapping and its application to concrete NT texts is huge, so much so that the value of the entire project is put in jeopardy. Furthermore, sound mapping requires reading in Greek. In this book, English translations in the Scholars Version are added to the Greek texts. But little is said about the actual sounds of *koine* Greek, which is not an unimportant issue, the authors' disclaimer to the contrary. For me, the closest sound approximation is that of modern Greek, not any artificial creation of the Renaissance or eighteenth to nineteenth centuries. Bottom line: a technical treatise that introduces a controversial cutting-edge theory that (whatever its eventual acceptance) will be of interest only to a small number of scholars.

Casimir Bernas
Holy Trinity Abbey

READING ROMANS IN POMPEII: PAUL'S LETTER AT GROUND LEVEL. By Peter Oakes. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress and London: Society for Promoting Christian Knowledge, 2009. Pp. xiii + 194. Cloth, \$39.00.

Oakes draws upon archaeological evidence from the Insula of the Menander in Pompeii to construct a picture of "typical" auditors of Paul's letter to the house churches in Rome. "Sabina" represents the very poor, female craftworker, "Iris" the barmaid represents the social situation of a slave who is, at times, subject to sexual exploitation, and "Primus" the fire stoker for a household bathhouse boiler stands in for the middle-aged slave doing menial work with no prospect of emancipation. Primus' master, "Holconius," is the best off of the samples, albeit not of the elite; a cabinet-maker by trade, he hosts the church in his large house. Oakes cogently and patiently builds a case for such diverse social stratification within an urban house-based church and then demonstrates how each type's social situation would affect their (different) hearing of Paul's rhetoric in Romans. This is nicely contrasted in places with typical readings of

modern commentators. Despite the difficulty of the task, Oakes has produced a book that is engaging to read, stimulating in its thesis, creative in its exegetical readings, and solidly grounded in its research. Graduate students and scholars will appreciate the careful groundwork that supports fresh readings of Romans.

Richard S. Ascough
Queen's University at Kingston

BELIAL UND KATECHON. EINE UNTERSUCHUNG ZU 2 THESS 2,1-12 UND 1 THESS 4,13-5,11. By Fritz W. Röcker. WUNT II/262. Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2009. Cloth. Pp. xvii + 604. Cloth, €84.00.

In this revised dissertation, Röcker first tries to define accurately the term *Belial/Beliar* (2 Cor 6:15) within its broader contexts. Next, he analyses the eschatological ruminations in 1 Thess 4:13-5:11 and 2 Thess 2:1-12. The term *Belial/Beliar* demarcates an outlaw, a figure who is also referred to as *anomos* in 2 Thess 2:3-8. Together the eschatology of 1 Thessalonians 4-5 and 2 Thessalonians 2 have demonstrative similarities with the synoptic apocalypse in Matthew 24, particularly in their understanding of the sequence of events. In addition, the statements in 2 Thessalonians 2 can be explained as an organic development of 1 Thessalonians 4-5, which means that the reference to the different eschatological depictions in these two passages is no longer a valid argument for a post-Pauline authorship of 2 Thessalonians. Although focused and complex, the book is interesting not only for university instructors and students but also for school teachers and pastors. That being said, it lacks innovation and creativity in its approach. In addition, the book lacks scientific critical distance and the hermeneutical predisposition of the author infuses the rather conservative interpretations.

Thomas Witulski
Westfälische Wilhelms-Universität Münster

CHRIST-BELIEVERS IN EPHESUS: A TEXTUAL ANALYSIS OF EARLY CHRISTIAN IDENTITY FORMATION IN A LOCAL PERSPECTIVE. By Mikael Tellbe. WUNT 242. Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2009. Pp. x + 363. Cloth, €89.00.

Using 1-2 Timothy, Revelation (esp. 2:1-7), the Johannine letters, and Ignatius' letter to the Ephesians (but not canonical "Ephesians" since its destination is ambiguous), Tellbe demonstrates that there is both diversity and consistency among various groups of Christ-believers in the region of Ephesus. Chapter 1 provides a survey of scholarship on Christianity at Ephesus, focusing on 1995 to the present. Chapter 2 contextualizes the formation and articulation of self-identity among the Ephesian Christ-believers in relationship to Judaism and Jewish ethnic identity. Chapter 3 explores expressions of rivalry and controversy, noting that accusations of "deviance" are more about self-definition and self-identity than about the ostensible "other." Chapter 4

focus on how the writers articulate the values, and the central story, that bind and legitimate their group. Having noted the diversity among the Christ-believer groups, chapter 5 gives attention to the coherence and consistency among them in the basic structure of the Jesus story and the ethical ideals it was expected to elicit. Tellbe concludes that Ephesus can rightly be deemed a “center of orthodoxy” in the late first and early second centuries. Thoroughly researched and employing some sociological theory, the book will prove invaluable to specialists.

Richard S. Ascough
Queen's University at Kingston

EPAPHRAS: PAUL'S EDUCATOR AT COLOSSAE. By Michael Trainor. *Paul's Social Network: Brothers and Sisters in Faith.* Collegeville, MN: Liturgical Press, 2008. Pp. xi + 123. Paper, \$12.95.

Trainor aims to demonstrate the centrality of Epaphras in the growth of the Jesus groups in the Lycus Valley. He argues that Epaphras was a very close associate and friend to Paul who principally guaranteed the transmission of Pauline teaching to the next generation of Jesus followers after the apostle's death. A distinctive contribution of this work comes in its methodology that applies social network analysis to the letters referring to Epaphras in order to reconstruct a portrait of Epaphras and his role in the development of the Pauline communities. The method is certainly worth exploring, though caution is warranted when applying modern sociological models to a first-century Mediterranean context. Trainor analyzes the Pauline network among the Jesus movement in the Lycus Valley to argue for a very intimate relationship between Paul and Epaphras that equipped him for an authoritative position as instructor among the Jesus groups of that region. Trainor's argument is built on only three occurrences of Epaphras' name, though, which leaves one hesitant to subscribe to the persuasiveness of such an extensive reconstruction built on so few mentions of the Pauline co-worker.

Matt O'Reilly
Jay United Methodist Church

LUKAN AUTHORSHIP OF HEBREWS. By David L. Allen. *NAC Studies in Bible and Theology.* Nashville: B & H Academic, 2010. Pp. xiv + 416. Cloth, \$24.99.

Allen, professor of preaching at Southwestern Baptist Seminary, does more in this volume than simply argue for the Lukan authorship of Hebrews. In fact, Allen offers an entire network of interrelated arguments for a new conservative understanding of the social location of Hebrews and Luke-Acts. At various points, Allen argues that the author of Luke-Acts was a Jewish traveling companion of Paul who wrote both Luke and Acts before 70 CE, that the intended reader of Luke-Acts was the former high priest, Theophilus, who served as high priest for four years (37-41 CE) before being deposed by Herod Agrippa, and that the

intended readership of Hebrews was composed of former Jewish priests in Syrian Antioch who converted to Christianity following Stephen's martyrdom. Allen is not reluctant to speculate well beyond the customary limits of scholarly reconstructions! Although nearly a quarter of this volume is composed of a detailed statistic comparison of the language and grammar in Luke-Acts and Hebrews, Allen's largely unquestioned presumption of the Pauline authorship of Ephesians and Colossians will cause many readers to doubt his credentials as a truly reliable arbiter of authorship in the New Testament. In spite of this volume, most scholars will continue to concur with Origen's conclusion about the authorship of Hebrews: only God knows.

Thomas E. Phillips
Point Loma Nazarene University

COPING WITH PREJUDICE: 1 PETER IN SOCIAL-PSYCHOLOGICAL PERSPECTIVE. By Paul A. Holloway. *WUNT 244.* Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2009. Pp. xvi + 317. Cloth, \$177.50.

For Holloway, 1 Peter is perhaps the earliest effort—by a Gentile Christian (a presbyter?) living in Anatolia around the beginning of the second century—to produce a far-reaching reply to the pervasive prejudice against Christians on the part of surrounding pagan society, a prejudice which occasionally broke out into active persecution by the state. The author's reply to his readers included coping mechanisms not dissimilar to those studied in our modern era. Pretending to be Peter the Apostle and well-versed in a Greek version of the Hebrew Bible as well as Christian writings, the author consoles his Christian compatriots by urging them to reflect upon the apocalyptic rewards that await them in the near future. Their sufferings are an echo of the sufferings that Christ himself endured. They are to cope by the harmony of their lives, coexisting with, yet not following the ways of, the world. They must show themselves as posing no subversive threat to the political, economic, or social order—perceived threats that occasioned prejudice in the first place. First Peter is therefore not a baptismal homily, but a real letter of consolation and advice devoted to a specific problem. By way of evaluation, Holloway's achievement is outstanding and merits serious attention not only from students of 1 Peter, but from all NT specialists.

Casimir Bernas
Holy Trinity Abbey

JESUS AND THE LAND: THE NEW TESTAMENT CHALLENGE TO “HOLY LAND” THEOLOGY. By Gary M. Burge. Grand Rapids, MI: Baker Academic, 2010. Pp. xiv + 153. Paper, \$21.99.

Though others have already written magisterially about the Gospel and the land of Israel (best of all, W. D. Davies, *The Gospel and the Land*), there is always room for additional insights. Burge, for his part, sequentially discusses the land

of promise in the OT, Diaspora Judaism, Jesus, the fourth Gospel, Acts, Paul and his successors, and in the theology of the church. For Israel, the land was inexorably connected to their religious obligations. But with the rise of the Diaspora, the Jews were perceived by outsiders as a religious group even without the expedient of territorial support. Jesus, despite limiting his message to the lost sheep of Israel, was no advocate of Jewish nationalistic claims to the land. Later NT personages followed in his footsteps. The story of Jesus glorified, and not a narrative about Judea and its renewal, laid the foundation for the Christian legend. Nevertheless, Paul avows that Jews in the period before the Parousia have not been abandoned by God even if they do not confess Jesus as Messiah, because God is ever faithful to his promises. When the End does come, however, they will recognize Jesus and thereby become full participants in the ongoing drama of salvation. In sum, this short treatise provides a balanced overview of a biblically-rooted motif that has repercussions in today's headlines. As a side note, a printer's error throughout the book has reversed the sequence of odd and even pages.

Casimir Bernas
Holy Trinity Abbey

MARANATHA: WOMEN'S FUNERARY RITUALS AND CHRISTIAN ORIGINS. By Kathleen E. Corley. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress Press, 2010. Pp. xvi + 262. Cloth, \$35.00.

For Corley, the stories of the passion and resurrection of Jesus in the Gospels (and 1 Cor 15) originated in the grassroots participation of women (and lower class people in general) in funerary rituals, meals, and laments as practiced in the Greco-Roman world, rather than in the perceptions of "elite leaders and male apostles." Proofs from Scripture and scribal literary production were not enough to account for the origins of the stories in question. For Corley this postulates a "nonsupernatural" source for early Christian communities, the Gospel tradition, and resurrection appearances. Those who took part in the "cult of the dead" encountered the departed in their imaginations, a normal experience for the grieving. Scholars will continue to examine Corley's suggestions (her own description), with the realization that, as so often happens in biblical studies, there is no way for any of them to be actually "proved." If one accepts (as I do) that the resurrection stories are literary creations that illustrate pre-existing creedal statements based upon firm foundations, then the cult of the dead may indeed provide a possible (not necessarily probable) *Sitz im Leben* for them (without the extinction, pace Corley, of the "supernatural"). All in all, this provocative work is bound to stimulate readers' feelings, arouse from dogmatic slumbers, and cause a re-examination (though hardly a jettisoning) of long-held opinions.

Casimir Bernas
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JENSEITS VON INDIKATIV UND IMPERATIV: KON-TEXTE UND NORMEN NEUTESTAMENTLICHER ETHIK/CONTEXTS AND NORMS OF NEW TESTAMENT ETHICS. Edited by Friedrich Wilhelm Horn and Ruben Zimmermann. WUNT 238. Vol. 1. Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2009. Pp. xiii + 386. Cloth, \$187.50.

These eighteen collected essays (two of them in English) are the product of roundtable discussions held in 2007 at Bad Münster am Stein-Ebernburg on the theme of the foundations of NT ethics, with special emphasis on the viability of the classic "indicative-imperative" model. The treatise consists of three main sections: NT ethics in dialog with the world from which it issued and with its contemporary milieu; fundamental structure of Pauline ethics; basic ethical forms and norms in the Gospels, Letter of James, and the early post-NT church. Among the many topics treated are the following: the Sages and their relation to the world; the art of living and ethics in Plutarch, Seneca, Philo, and 1 Peter; elements of eudaemonism in the NT; Paul and Epictetus; the fundamental structures of Pauline ethics; the philosophical coherence of the sermon on the plain; ethics and anthropology in the letter of James; controversies in Hellenistic Judaism and Paul on whether virtue can be learned; the content of Pauline ethics in 1 Corinthians. All in all, these penetrating scientific essays furnish ample proof of the influence of environment in the formation of the NT.

Casimir Bernas
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JESUS OUR PRIEST: A CHRISTIAN APPROACH TO THE PRIESTHOOD OF CHRIST. By Gerald O'Collins and Michael Keenan Jones. Oxford/New York: Oxford University Press, 2010. Pp. xi + 311. Cloth, \$45.00.

A renowned Jesuit theologian and a diocesan priest collaborate to present a Christian explanation of the priesthood of Christ. Successive chapters treat the relevant material: Jewish matrix of the Synoptic and Johannine Gospels; Paul, 1 Peter, and Revelation; Hebrews; a select group of Church Fathers; Aquinas and the Middle Ages; Luther and Calvin; the council of Trent and the French school of spirituality; Newman and others; twelve synthetic theses resulting from the previous presentation; sharing Christ's priesthood with others. It is no surprise that Paul and Hebrews are the main sources for a developed notion of Christ as priest; they are supported by random texts from other portions of the NT. According to O'Collins and Jones, all the baptized share in the function of Christ as priest, prophet, and king. This sharing can bring tension and conflict with the ordained clergy, as well as persecution by outsiders. Christ established some of his followers as priestly ministers during his public life, at the last supper, and after the resurrection. The authors of this well-researched treatise have expounded the relevant data with concise precision. Their conclusions, however, about an ordained priesthood with special powers beyond that of the baptized in general will resonate more

with Catholics and Orthodox than with those Christians who interpret the evidence in less clerical manner.

Casimir Bernas
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MAGNIFYING GOD IN CHRIST: A SUMMARY OF NEW TESTAMENT THEOLOGY. By Thomas R. Schreiner. Grand Rapids, MI: Baker Academic, 2010. Pp. 272. Paper, \$24.99.

Schreiner presents an abbreviated version of his 990-page *New Testament Theology: Magnifying God in Christ* (Baker Academic, 2008). He has eliminated nearly all footnotes and compressed the arguments, but the volume is an adequate digest of the larger treatise. Each chapter ends with a brief conclusion and pastoral reflection. The same operative principles and conclusions are here at work. The Kingdom of God is not the church, but is at work within it. Jesus was not mistaken about the imminence of the Kingdom; if he were, then his life and teachings would no longer be germane. Eschatology, theology, Christology, the Holy Spirit, sin, faith, obedience, the people of the promise, the fulfillment of the OT in the NT—all these compose the main facets of NT teaching. All in all, because Schreiner adopts a less-critical approach than many currents of modern day scholarship, his able treatise will be especially conducive to those who share his own presuppositions of biblical relevance.

Casimir Bernas
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THE BIBLE IN HUMAN TRANSFORMATION: TOWARD A NEW PARADIGM FOR BIBLICAL STUDY. By Walter Wink. Minneapolis, MN: Fortress Press, 2010. Pp. x + 85. Paper, \$9.99.

There is an immense amount of wisdom and insight in this republication of Wink's slight essay from 1973, now equipped with a new Preface and Afterward by M. Borg. Among his intentions is to understand the actions of the human Christ before he was confessed as the divine Christ. Wink throws down the gauntlet with his provocative programmatic statement: "Historical biblical criticism is bankrupt." By the end of his treatise, however, Wink has rescued criticism but directed it towards its ultimate object, which is to serve the faith of the living community. To do this he steers a perilous course between the Scylla of Modernism and the Charybdis of Fundamentalism. I heartily agree with his conclusions, with the proviso that the divorce between scholarly criticism and church life is far less serious in the Catholic Church than in many other forms of Christianity. In short, a capital achievement!

Casimir Bernas
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CODEX TCHACOS: TEXTE UND ANALYSEN. Edited by Johanna Brankaer and Hans-Gebhard Bethge. Texte und Untersuchungen zur Geschichte der altchristlichen

Literatur, 161. Berlin: Walter de Gruyter, 2007. Pp. vi + 485. Cloth, €134.95, \$189.00.

This volume contains the four tractates of the Codex Tchacos first published in a critical edition by the National Geographic Society in early 2007. It is remarkable that the editors could publish a much better edition just a year after the text became available online. Their edition contains the Coptic text, with German translation, of *Letter of Peter to Philip* (CT 1), together with the Nag Hammadi version (NHC VIII,1) published in parallel columns; text and translation of the *(First) Apocalypse of James* (CT 2), with NHC V,3 in parallel columns; text and translation of the *Gospel of Judas* (CT 3); and text and translation of the *Book of Allogenes* (CT 4). Each tractate is supplied with a short introduction plus indices of Coptic words and grammatical forms, followed by a very extensive commentary ("Beobachtungen"). The book concludes with a chapter on the Codex Tchacos as a collection, plus bibliography and indices. Especially valuable are the editions of the first two tractates because they are published with both extant versions in parallel columns. In their edition of the *Gospel of Judas* the editors rightly interpret the figure of Judas as a negative character (associated with the thirteenth *archontic* sphere) instead of the heroic Judas presented by the NGS editors. Since additional fragments of the *Gospel of Judas* have recently come to light, a new critical edition is warranted. Brankaer and Bethge would be the obvious scholars to produce it, given the quality of this volume.

Birger A. Pearson
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THE PARAPHRASE OF SHEM (NH VII,1): INTRODUCTION, TRANSLATION AND COMMENTARY. By Michel Roberge. Nag Hammadi and Manichaean Studies 72. Leiden: Brill, 2010. Pp. xi + 189. Cloth, €86.00, \$122.00.

The *Paraphrase of Shem* is one of the longest and best-preserved tractates of the Nag Hammadi corpus. It is also the most difficult, owing to corruptions and confusions found in it. It bears no relationship at all to any of the other NH tractates, though its three-part system is probably related somehow to that of the *Paraphrase of Seth* discussed by Hippolytus (*Ref.* 5.19-22). Roberge has devoted more study to this text than any other scholar. The book here reviewed is based on his edition published in the Laval series in 2000 (*Bibliothèque copte de Nag Hammadi*, "Textes," 25). In his lengthy introduction to the tractate, Roberge treats such issues as the tractate's literary genre ("apocalypse"), narrative procedure, Gnostic system, provenance, and date. Roberge suggests an early-third-century date for the tractate with several traits anticipating Manichaeism. The English translation (the Coptic is not included) is followed by a commentary, bibliography, and indices. This is an impressive work, but not everyone will agree with the author's interpretation of some passages, e.g., his treatment of the term "paraphrase" (1,1.2; 32,17)

and his interpretation of 38,28-40,31 as referring to the crucifixion of Jesus.

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History of Christianity (Early)

ROMAN DEATH: THE DYING AND THE DEAD IN ANCIENT ROME. By Valerie M. Hope. London: Continuum, 2009. Pp. xii + 239; plates. Cloth, \$60.00.

There is certainly no dearth of work being done on death and burial in the Roman world. What is hard to come by, however, is an accessible work of synthesis that is fascinating, well written, and useful for undergraduates, graduate students, and scholars alike, while providing an overview of the exciting world of Roman death, from the first century BCE to second century CE. If this is what you are looking for, this new book by one of the foremost experts on Roman social and cultural history of death should not be missed. Arranged thematically—addressing such topics as how a typical Roman prepared for the inevitable, causes of death, rituals, and beliefs about the state of the person after life—this book does a fine job of uncovering what for some may seem a strange world in which death was woven into everyday life. Hope merges literary, epigraphic, archeological, and architectural sources into what can only be called a monument to interdisciplinarity. Richly illustrated with seventeen plates, and exquisitely documented with notes and a full bibliography, this work will certainly find its place in research libraries, on college syllabi, and on graduate school reading lists alongside such authoritative works as J. M. C. Toynbee, *Death and Burial in the Roman World* (Cornell University Press, 1971) and Ian Morris, *Death-Ritual and Social Structure in Classical Antiquity* (Cambridge University Press, 1992), among other classics—though to my mind, Hope's work not only augments, but in some ways supersedes them.

Dennis P. Quinn
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EMPTY BOTTLES OF GENTILISM: KINGSHIP AND THE DIVINE IN LATE ANTIQUITY AND THE EARLY MIDDLE AGES (TO 1050). By Francis Oakley. New Haven, CT: Yale University Press, 2010. Pp. xiii + 306. Cloth, \$38.00.

This first volume of a planned trilogy on Western political thought's medieval origins sets the project on a firm foundation. Oakley aims to reshape the constitutive narrative of Western politics by moving the Middle Ages from a bizarre aberration disrupting the continuity between classical Greece and modern Europe to the crucible of change from Antiquity to Modernity. He makes two principal points. First, he argues that globally, including ancient Greece, the default political form was sacred

kingship. Second, he locates the first conceptual challenges to this default among the biblical Hebrews and New Testament Christians. Furthermore, he identifies Augustine of Hippo as unique in recognizing the biblical viewpoint and developing a reasoned rejection of an archaic sacral pattern for politics, even though this aspect of his work was not immediately received by medieval audiences. The book is divided into three sections. First is an introduction that previews Oakley's trilogy. Second comes a discussion of cosmic kingship in Antiquity with its "Abrahamic departure." Third is a treatment of late antique and early medieval political ideas, eastern and western, including Augustine and his subsequent interpretation. Oakley's engagement with the historiography of political thought as well as his juxtaposition of particular political philosophies well serve scholars looking to rethink the development of political thought in the West. Short historical summaries prefacing each section supply general background, making the book accessible to students and general interest audiences as well.

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QUINTI SEPTIMI FLORENTIS TERTULLIANI DE ANIMA. By J. H. Waszink. Leiden: Brill. 2010. Pp. xxv + 654. \$272.00.

J. H. Waszink's 1947 edition of Tertullian's *De Anima*, published by J. M. Meulenhoff, Amsterdam, needs little introduction. Long out of print, it is published again as a celebratory 100th volume of the *Supplements to Vigiliae Christianae* series, which began in 1987 with Waszink and J. C. M. van Winden's critical text and translation of Tertullian's *De Idololatria*. This edition of the *De Anima*, which has in fact become the definitive edition of Tertullian's work, is exactly what is contained: a photocopied transfer of that classic work. The new packaging contains a very brief overview of the eminent scholar's career (two and a half pages); an English translation of part of Waszink's introduction to his 1980 German publication of *De Anima* (thirteen pages); and a short Errata of the few typographical errors E. P. Meijering identified in the original edition (one and a half pages). The republication of this authoritative work by one of the greatest patristic scholars of the twentieth century is certainly justifiable, and Brill is to be applauded. However, Brill also missed an opportunity to do much more justice to the original had they re-typeset the manuscript (some letters are cut off in the transfer and some pages are blurry), made the few changes indicated in the Errata in the text itself, and updated the bibliography, which is perhaps the greatest flaw since, though definitive at the time, it is now over sixty-three years old. Unfortunately, this worthy tribute is hampered by the very little effort put into its literal reproduction.

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